NewsBank inc.

No, California is not banning Skittles - The California Food Safety Act will ban four food additives beginning in 2027, but the law doesn't affect Skittles. We VERIFY why.

October 11, 2023 | NBC - 5 KING (Seattle, WA)
Author: Megan Loe | Section: Food | 459 Words
OpenURL Link

On Oct. 7, California Gov. Gavin Newsom that's been as the state's "Skittles ban."

The California Food Safety Act will ban the use of common food additives such as red dye No. 3.

Several , including , claim California is banning Skittles because the candies contain at least one of the banned additives.

THE QUESTION

Is California banning Skittles?

THE SOURCES

*

*

*

* Ingredients lists for Skittles candies

THE ANSWER

No, California is not banning Skittles.

WHAT WE FOUND

Many people have referred to the California Food Safety Act as a "Skittles ban" because the legislation, when it was first proposed, of in food products. The chemical is used and other foods to enhance their color and sheen.

But the no longer bans titanium dioxide. It only lists four food additives: red dye No. 3, brominated vegetable oil, potassium bromate and propylparaben.

The law prohibits any person or entity from manufacturing or selling a food product that contains any of these four chemicals beginning in 2027.

"Skittles sold in America do not contain any of the four ingredients" listed in the California Food Safety Act, a spokesperson for Gov. Gavin Newsom said.

VERIFY also searched the ingredients lists for all and did not find any of the four food additives that will be banned in California.

Skittles' manufacturer Mars did not respond to a request for comment.

California Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel (D-Encino), who authored the law, that it does not outright ban any

products, either.

"It would instead require companies to make modifications to products sold in California and likely prompt a nationwide transition to safer alternatives," he said.

, Newsom also said delaying the bill's implementation until 2027 gives brands "significant time…to revise their recipes to avoid these harmful chemicals."

"Californians will still be able to access and enjoy their favorite food products, with greater confidence in the safety of such products," Newsom said.

and would need to reformulate their products under the law, since they contain red dye No. 3.

Some sodas, including , contain brominated vegetable oil. The food additive is used to keep citrus flavor from separating in beverages.

Potassium bromate is used as an oxidizing agent in various types of bread and baked goods, while propylparaben is commonly used in small amounts as a preservative in food and beverages.

The National Confectioners Association (NCA), a trade organization for candy makers, has voiced its opposition to the California Food Safety Act.

"This law replaces a uniform national food safety system with a patchwork of inconsistent state requirements created by legislative fiat that will increase food costs," the NCA . "This is a slippery slope that the FDA could prevent by engaging on this important topic. We should be relying on the scientific rigor of the FDA in terms of evaluating the safety of food ingredients and additives."

.

© 2023 King Broadcasting Company, a subsidiary of Belo Corp. All Rights Reserved.

- **Citation (apa Style)**
  Loe, M. (2023, October 11). No, California is not banning Skittles - The California Food Safety Act will ban four food additives beginning in 2027, but the law doesn't affect Skittles. We VERIFY why.. *NBC - 5 KING (Seattle, WA)*. Available from NewsBank: Access World News – Historical and Current: https://infoweb.newsbank.com/apps/news/document-view?p=WORLDNEWS&docref=news/1949C2640FCC9DE0.